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HEADQUARTERS BERLIN COMMAND
OFFICE OF MILITARY GOVERNMENT FOR GERMANY (US)
BERLIN, GERMANY

S-2 Branch

AFPO 701, US ARMY

3 December 1947

SUBJECT: "Flying Saucers"

TO : Deputy Director of Intelligence
European Command, Frankfurt
APO 757, US Army

Attention: Lt Skidmore

1. Reference is made to letter, your office, file 350.09 (GID/OPS/IS), dated 21 October 1947, subject "Transmittal of EKI on Alleged 'Flying Saucer'."

2. As far as could be ascertained from a reliable source, who was employed during the war by the Office for Research ("Amt fuer Entwicklung: Versuchs und Erprobungs Flugzeugs") of the High Command of the Air Force, in Berlin, no flying saucer was ever developed by any German air research institute or factory. It is true, however, that following the ideas of the Horten brothers, a certain number of "flying wings" were built and test-flown. A Messerschmidt test pilot named OTTIE was known to be a specialist in that field. In the course of this program interesting research was done by the German Research Institute for Gliders ("Deutsche Forschungsanstalt fuer Segelflug"), located in EMDING, Bavaria.

3. The head of this institute was a Professor GEORGE, a very good friend of the HORTEN brothers. He had talked to them a few times about their idea of the parabolic design of aircraft, and initiated some research on the subject.

4. Several models were designed of a parabolic type of aircraft which has a crescent plan form. The first design of that kind was completed in Autumn 1944 and was simply the rounded up form of an existing HORTEN "flying wing", the strongly tapered wing being modified to a parabola. The second design was not a true crescent, inasmuch as the parabola was applied only to the outer (front edge), while the rear edge, with its stabilizers, was maintained straight, as in the original "flying wing". The resulting design looked very much like a round cake with a large sector cut out.

5. When the model was finally built, it had a wing span of approximately nineteen (19) feet, and was given the official designation of DF3-326. It had no engine and was tested as a glider only. Part of the

US - Republic (Wright 7-4-48)

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(Ltr to ODDI, EUCOM, 3 Dec 47, subj: "Flying Saucers")

test included a two behind another aircraft at the speed of approximately 140 miles. A series of tests was arranged to obtain the best possible depth of the wing, for a maximum of length stability from front to rear of aircraft. An iron tube was installed going from front to rear at the center of the wing with a small weight attached to it in such a manner that it could be moved in the fashion of a rider. This served to change the center of gravity. The weight, of course, was not excessive, being in relation to the size of the craft.

6. While the length stability of the craft was excellent as long as the center of gravity was not shifted, it showed a tendency to get into a spin as soon as the weight on the iron tube shifted from one point to another. Around Christmas, 1944, the depth of the wing was modified and tested to be in a certain relation to the distance between vertex and focal point of the parabola, whose formula determined the shape of the wing. This distance (P) was supposed to be the depth of the wing; possibly $2P$ or $\frac{1}{2}P$.

7. No new startling reports arrived at the HKL after Christmas of 1944, and our source is very emphatic that if this design should have been improved and finally extended to a circular or oval shape, he would have heard of it. At the same time, he is quite convinced that such a design would be the final outcome of all experiments conducted at present "flying wings".

8. Attached sketches give an approximate idea of the design and model used in the "Deutsche Forschungsanstalt fuer Segelflug" in ELBRING. Attempts will be made to contact the HORTEN brothers and secure more information on the subject.

1 Incl
Sketch

Harry H. Pretty
HARRY H. PRETTY
Lt Col GSC
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Copy furnished:
Director of Intelligence, OMCUS

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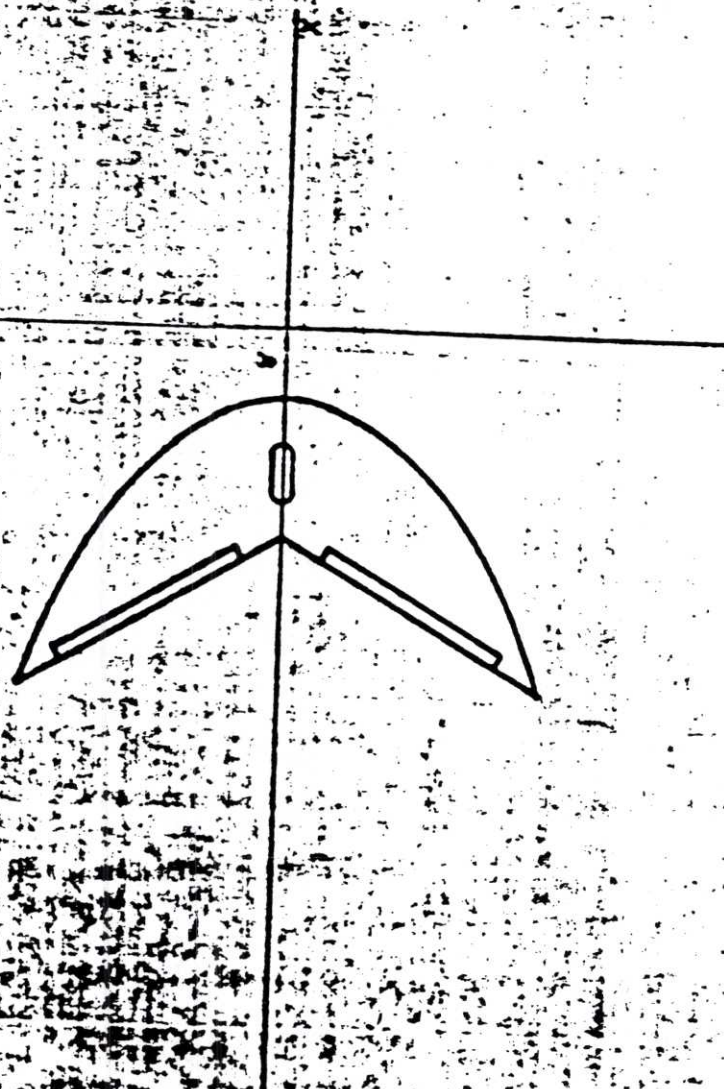
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